



PAPUA NEW GUINEA IS THE EASTERN HALF of a large island in the

HULI

Pacific Ocean with a number of islands surrounding it. The western half of the island is Irian Jaya—part of Indonesia. The inland central area rises

THE WIG PEOPLE OF THE HIGHLANDS

The Huli

The Huli people live in the central mountains of Papua New Guinea in rain forest that is so dense that no outsider knew they existed until the 1930s. Like many of the peoples on the island, ceremonies and festivals are a major part of life—they are not only important within the group, but also to form alliances with different clans. Self-decoration is a large part of the ceremonies.

In a nation where no written word exists, an important form of education is song and dance.



EVERYDAY LIFE

The Huli live in small scattered settlements, each with its own plot of land on which they grow food such as sweet potatoes and taro. Walls surround the area both to keep the livestock in and the evil spirits and enemies out. Men and women live in separate houses, the women traditionally living with the pigs, which are the Huli's most valued possession.

THE HULI WARRIOR

From the day a Huli boy is born he is taught how to be a warrior and to defend his family. Clans often have disagreements, mainly over land, women, or pigs, which can lead to fighting. Pigs are often exchanged to settle disputes and compensate for injury or death.

